

INVITATION & GREETING CARD APP — MINIMUM VIABLE PRODUCT

Fix what every competitor **gets wrong.** Add nothing else.

A premium, reliable invitation & greeting card app for India and the Indian diaspora — audited against 10 market leaders, engineered for trust, and stripped of every non-essential feature. No AI content. One promise: preview always matches what is sent.

PROMISE #1 — RELIABILITY

True WYSIWYG editor. Pixel-accurate. Verified on 3 device classes before release.

PROMISE #2 — NO FRICTION

3-way RSVP (Yes / No / Maybe). Guests need no app — just a link.

PROMISE #3 — NO SURPRISES

One free tier, one premium tier. One comparison table. Zero hidden paywalls.

Document Owner — Product Team

Status — Final for Build Kickoff •  Approved

AI Policy — Zero AI content / design features in V1

Scope Philosophy — Every feature passed a “100% requirement” test

PREMIUM • RELIABLE • INDIAN-FIRST

18 OCCASIONS • 200 TEMPLATES • ONE CODEBASE

CONTENTS — 13 SECTIONS + APPENDIX

Table of Contents

A lean PRD. Nine screens. Thirteen sections. Every line earned its place — if it didn't pass the "100% required for V1" test, it lives in the V2 Roadmap (§10), not here.

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DOCUMENT CONTROL		FINAL • BUILD KICKOFF
DOCUMENT	Invitation & Greeting Card App — Product Requirements Document (MVP) — Qwen Refined V1	
VERSION	1.0 • 07 September 2026	
STATUS	• FINAL Approved for build kickoff. No open questions.	
CLASSIFICATION	Internal + Build Partner • Confidential	
AI POLICY	ZERO AI content / design features in V1 — chatbot allowed only for support FAQ troubleshooting	
PLATFORM SCOPE	One cross-platform codebase (React Native or Flutter) — iOS & Android. Web/desktop is V2.	

**Scope Philosophy — Read this first.** V1 is not a smaller version of the competition. It is a *sharper* one. Every feature below had to pass a single test: *"Is this 100% required to beat competitors on reliability, RSVP UX, trust, and Indian-festival coverage?"* If it didn't, it was moved to the V2 Roadmap (§10). That discipline is why V1 ships in 12–14 weeks.

SECTION 01 — THE NORTH STAR

1 Vision

Do fewer things than the top 10 — and do them without bugs, without paywall tricks, and with cultural respect.

A cross-platform invitation and greeting card app that **feels more premium and more reliable than any of the top 10 apps studied** — Partiful, Punchbowl, CardSnacks, Evite, Greetings Island, Paperless Post, Canva, Invyt, Adobe Express, and Invitaciones Digitales.

We achieve leadership not by matching their breadth, but by **fixing what every competitor gets wrong** — editor unreliability, hidden paywalls, forced app installs, binary RSVP, and absent Indian-festival coverage — while covering both Western and Indian occasions from day one.

VISION STATEMENT

V1 is not a smaller version of the competition. It is a sharper one. Doing fewer things, doing them without bugs, and serving both Western and Indian celebrations equally well is the entire strategy.

SECTION 02 — WHAT WE WILL & WILL NOT DO

2 Goals & Non-Goals

Five explicit goals — each tied to a deliberate V1 decision that closes a repeated competitor failure.

GOAL	HOW V1 ACHIEVES IT
Beat competitors on reliability	True WYSIWYG editor with technical enforcement — preview always matches sent output. Fixes the #1 complaint across Greetings Island & Canva (\$5 technical spec).
Beat competitors on RSVP UX	3-way RSVP (Yes / No / Maybe) — guest needs <i>no app install</i> , responds via link. Fixes Punchbowl's friction and matches Partiful's best practice (\$6.2).
Beat competitors on trust	One free tier, one paid tier, no hidden paywalls — single visible comparison table. Directly fixes Punchbowl's #1 complaint (\$6.9).
Win Indian + Western audience	Both festival sets live at launch with cultural-accuracy validation — not bolted on later. 5 pan-India festivals at day one (\$6.4).
Ship fast	No AI content, one send channel (email), one calendar (Google), curated template count (200) — scope discipline compresses build to 12–14 weeks.

⊖ NON-GOALS FOR V1 — EXPLICITLY OUT OF SCOPE

AI message / design generation • SMS / WhatsApp sending • Animated cards • Gift cards • Licensed characters • Print-on-demand • Regional languages beyond English/Hindi • Niche regional festivals • Web / desktop app • Multi-user collaboration.
These are not “rejected” — they are sequenced. See V2 Roadmap (\$10).

SECTION 03 — WHO WE SERVE

3 Target Audience

Broad, not niche — narrowing comes after usage data, not before.

V1 targets anyone in India or the Indian diaspora sending an invitation or greeting for a birthday, wedding, anniversary, or major festival — Indian or Western. No sub-segment targeting yet.

Segmentation (e.g., by life-stage, city tier, or diaspora corridor) is a V2 decision once usage data reveals demand concentration. Starting broad maximizes learning and avoids premature optimization.

AUDIENCE PRINCIPLE

One persona for V1: "The Organizer." The person who picks a template, personalizes it in under 3 minutes, sends it, and needs reliable RSVPs back — without chasing guests or apologizing for a broken card.

- BIRTHDAY
- WEDDING
- ANNIVERSARY
- DIWALI
- CHRISTMAS
- + 12 MORE

SECTION 04 — WHY V1 WINS — FIVE GAPS NO COMPETITOR CLOSED

4 Competitive Gap Summary

Five gaps showed up repeatedly across all 10 apps' reviews. V1 closes all five deliberately — each with a named fix and a section reference.

Editor Unreliability
Preview doesn't match final output. Top complaint for Greetings Island & Canva.

Fix → Technical WYSIWYG enforcement

\$5 SPEC

Hidden Paywalls
Users pay and still can't find features. Punchbowl's #1 complaint.

Fix → Transparent single comparison table

\$6.9

Forced App Downloads
Guests forced to install an app to RSVP. Only Partiful solved this.

Fix → Link-based RSVP, zero install

\$6.2

Binary RSVP Only
No "Maybe" option. Causes inaccurate headcounts (Punchbowl / Evite).

Fix → 3-way RSVP: Yes / No / Maybe

\$6.2

No Indian Festival Support
Unserved need for 700M+ users. No app covers it authentically.

Fix → 5 pan-India festivals at launch

\$6.4 GATE

EVIDENCE BASE

10 apps audited: Partiful · Punchbowl · CardSnacks · Evite · Greetings Island · Paperless Post · Canva · Invyt · Adobe Express · Invitaciones Digitales · Store reviews, pricing pages, and editor QA tested before any V1 decision was locked.

SECTION 05 — THE EDITOR IS THE PRODUCT

5 The Editor — Audited Best Practices + Technical Precision

We did not design from scratch. We audited every competitor, kept only what users actually praised, and excluded everything powered by AI.

SOURCE APP	ADOPTED FEATURE	WHY IT WAS KEPT	EXPLICITLY SKIPPED
Paperless Post	Info “Blocks” for event details; envelope customization	Cleanest data/design separation; premium feel	“Magic Art” AI stickers
Evite	Fast field-based customization; potluck / sign-up list	Fastest time-to-send	—
Greetings Island	True WYSIWYG intent; save-as-favorite	Right intent, broken execution — we fix accuracy	Broken save/preview pipeline
Punchbowl	3-way RSVP; one-click contact import; exportable guest list	Fixes their own top complaint	Paywall structure
Partiful	Zero-install RSVP link; minimal theme customization	Removes biggest friction point	Limited template depth
Canva	Drag-drop precision with snapping / alignment guides	Best-in-class editing feel	Magic Resize, BG remover (AI)
CardSnacks	Simple photo-add flow	Lowest-friction personalization	AI message wizard, video/voice
Adobe Express	Typography quality as visual bar	Sets premium-feel target	Pro-design toolset bloat
Invyt	Simple template-field editing as UX baseline	Good floor for “easy for anyone”	—
Invitaciones Digitales	Occasion-first browsing pattern	Matches actual user search behavior	—

V1 EDITOR FEATURE LIST — WHAT SHIPS

Template gallery organized by **occasion (not design style)** • WYSIWYG canvas (release gate — see spec below) • Drag-and-drop text / photo with snapping guides • Info “Blocks” for event details (auto-feed RSVP + calendar) • Curated font set per template + small custom color picker • Photo upload with basic crop / brightness / contrast • Small curated sticker / emoji set (no marketplace) • Envelope-opening animation on guest page • One optional guest question • Auto-save drafts + unlimited undo/redo • Favorites / bookmarking.

⚙️ PRECISION SPEC — WYSIWYG CANVAS

Canvas renders at 2× device pixel ratio. Fonts preloaded via CDN before canvas init. Export uses IDENTICAL renderer as preview. QA parity test across iPhone SE, Pixel 7, iPad Mini required before release. Release Gate.

⚙️ PRECISION SPEC — PHOTO HANDLING

Max upload 5 MB. Client-side compression to 1080p WebP before storage. No AI background removal. Subsetted web fonts preloaded before render to prevent FOUT.

SECTION 06 — EVERYTHING THAT SHIPS IN V1

6 Core Feature Set

Nine sub-systems. Nothing more. Each one maps to a competitive gap or a trust requirement.



6.1 Accounts

Email/password + Google Sign-In.
No multi-step onboarding — straight to Home after signup. Firebase / Supabase auth.



6.2 Event Invitations

Create: title, date/time (timezone-aware), location, description, cover template.
Guest list: manual entry or **import from device contacts (email only)**.



6.3 Greeting Cards

Template → personalize → **send by email** (immediate or scheduled).
"Opened" tracking via pixel. Save as draft, resume anytime.

6.2 DETAIL — RSVP SYSTEM (KEY DIFFERENTIATOR)

3-way RSVP: Yes / No / Maybe — tracked in real time. • One optional custom guest question • Guest RSVPs via emailed link — **no app install required** • Printable / exportable guest list • Single automatic reminder email (24h before event) • Editing an event **re-notifies all guests automatically**.

6.4 TEMPLATE LIBRARY — FINALIZED V1 OCCASION SET

18 categories • 200 templates

EVERGREEN — 9

- BIRTHDAY
- WEDDING
- ANNIVERSARY
- THANK YOU
- CONGRATULATIONS
- GET WELL SOON
- NEW BABY
- HOUSEWARMING
- FAREWELL / RETIREMENT

10–15 curated templates each at launch. **Quality over volume.**

INDIAN FESTIVALS — 5

- DIWALI
- HOLI
- RAKSHA BANDHAN
- NAVRATRI / DURGA PUJA
- GANESH CHATURTHI

CULTURAL GATE

BROAD FESTIVALS — 4

- EID
- CHRISTMAS
- NEW YEAR
- VALENTINE'S DAY



Cultural Accuracy Gate: All Indian festival templates must pass cultural review — symbol accuracy, color appropriateness, text correctness — before inclusion. Visual appeal alone is insufficient. Domain-expert sign-off required.

6.5 Sending

Email only. Contains personalized card/invitation + direct RSVP/view link. Link is copyable for manual forwarding. Sent via SendGrid / SES.

SPF / DKIM / DMARC required. Mail-Tester ≥ 9/10 is a release gate.

6.6 Google Calendar Sync

Host: OAuth — event auto-created / updated / cancelled.
Guest: No OAuth — "Add to Calendar" generates standard .ics (Google / Outlook / Apple).

OUTLOOK/APPLE HOST = V2

6.7 Offline Mode

Create / edit offline using cached templates. Drafts stored locally. Actions auto-queue and fire when back online.

Status label: "Saved — will send when you're back online"

Conflict rule: Local timestamp wins. Server silently overwritten. No merge UI.

6.8 Customer Support

One **AI chatbot for FAQs / troubleshooting only** — support tooling, *not* content creation. Escalation to email support for unresolved queries. Lightweight hosted service; no custom LLM hosting.

6.9 Monetization — One Comparison, No Tricks

Free: Limited templates/category, capped events/cards/month, small unobtrusive watermark.

Premium (monthly / annual): All templates unlocked, no watermark, unlimited sends.

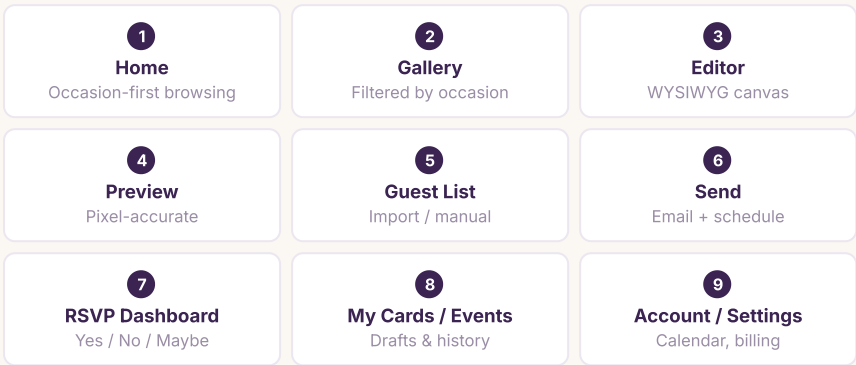
Single comparison table shown once — no hidden gates, ever.

SECTION 07 — NINE SCREENS, NOTHING EXTRA

7 Information Architecture

Nine screens total. No screen exists that doesn't serve a §6 feature.

PRIMARY FLOW — 9 SCREENS



IA RULE If a screen doesn't serve §6, it doesn't exist. Max 3 taps from Home to Preview.

NAVIGATION PRINCIPLES

- **Occasion-first** — users browse by “Diwali” or “Birthday”, not by design style. Matches Invitaciones Digitales pattern.
- **Guest is a link** — every send produces a copyable RSVP URL. No forced install.
- **Blocks feed systems** — Info Blocks auto-populate RSVP page + calendar .ics.
- **No onboarding carousel.** Signup → Home. Zero steps wasted.

SECTION 08 — PREMIUM IS CONSISTENCY

8 Design System

One signature palette. Consistency reads as premium; choice paralysis doesn't. Festival-specific colors live inside templates, not in chrome.

#3B2452 PRIMARY Twilight Plum Premium; works for formal + festive equally	#E8A33D ACCENT Marigold Gold Bridges Indian decor + Western autumn palettes	#F2726F SECONDARY ACCENT Blush Coral Love / celebration occasions	#FBF8F3 BACKGROUND Warm Ivory Neutral warmth, not clinical white	#241F26 TEXT Charcoal Ink High contrast, softer than pure black
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SUCCESS #2E9E6D	WARNING #E1A93B	ERROR #D64550	INFO #3D7EBF
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Typography

Headings: Warm serif or rounded-sans — *Fraunces, Playfair Display* — signals premium / editorial.
Body (Latin): Inter
Body (Hindi / Devanagari): Noto Sans Devanagari — paired to Inter for visual consistency.
Code / Spec: JetBrains Mono (technical callouts only)

Dark Mode

BACKGROUND #1C1620	SURFACE #241D29	TEXT #F3EDF7	ACCENT STAYS #E8A33D
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Accent stays Marigold in both modes for brand continuity.

SECTION 09 — MINIMAL BUILD TIME, MAXIMUM RELIABILITY

9 Technical Approach

One codebase, managed backend, serverless email — optimized for speed without compromising the two release gates: WYSIWYG accuracy & email deliverability.

LAYER	CHOICE	RATIONALE / NOTES
Mobile	One cross-platform codebase — React Native or Flutter for iOS + Android	Web app is V2. Single codebase halves build & QA.
Backend	Managed BaaS — Firebase or Supabase	Cuts weeks off V1. Firebase pairs naturally with Google Sign-In + Calendar API.
Email Delivery	SendGrid or AWS SES via serverless function	Open-tracking pixel for “opened” status. Transactional templates required.
Editor Rendering	Templates as structured JSON → single canvas engine (Fabric.js / Konva.js)	Same renderer produces preview AND final output . This is the WYSIWYG guarantee.
Font Strategy	Subsetted web fonts preloaded before canvas render	Prevents FOUT — no flash-of-unstyled-text causing parity drift.
Image Handling	Max 5 MB upload, client compress to 1080p WebP	No AI background removal in V1. Keeps pipeline deterministic.
Calendar Sync	Google Calendar API (host); standard .ics generation (guest)	Guest needs no API — .ics works with Google, Outlook, Apple.
Support Chatbot	Lightweight hosted service, trained on FAQ/help	No custom LLM hosting. FAQ / troubleshooting only — not content creation.

✓ RELEASE GATE — EMAIL DELIVERABILITY

Sending domain must have **SPF / DKIM / DMARC** configured. Transactional templates must achieve **Mail-Tester score ≥ 9/10** before launch. Spam delivery = broken premium promise.

✓ RELEASE GATE — EDITOR ACCURACY

QA must test **editor-preview vs. sent-output parity** across ≥ 3 device sizes (iPhone SE, Pixel 7, iPad Mini) before launch. Not a “nice-to-have.” 0 reported “preview ≠ sent” bugs is a launch KPI.

SECTION 10 — NOTHING HERE IS BAD — IT’S SIMPLY SEQUENCED

10 **V2 Roadmap — Explicitly Deferred**

Everything below is valuable — and deliberately not in V1. Building it now slows the launch that needs to happen first.

CATEGORY	DEFERRED ITEMS
AI	AI message wizard, AI background removal, AI design suggestions
Sending Channels	SMS, WhatsApp, social direct-share
Festivals & Language	Pongal, Onam, Karva Chauth, Baisakhi, Maha Shivaratri, Makar Sankranti + Tamil, Telugu, Kannada, Marathi UI
Card Types	Animated cards, video / voice messages
Commerce	Gift card integration, physical gift delivery, print-on-demand
Content	Licensed character templates
Calendar	Outlook and Apple host-side sync
Platform	Web app, desktop app
Collaboration	Multi-user co-editing, comments
Editor	Sticker marketplace, gradient / layer tools, template remixing
Business	B2B / enterprise tier, community template marketplace

V2 scope will be reprioritized based on V1 retention, conversion, and festival-usage data.

SECTION 11 — HOW WE KNOW V1 WORKED

11 **Success Metrics & Analytics**

Seven KPIs — each tied to a PRD promise. If these move, V1 succeeded.

ACTIVATION 24h % new users who create + send first card/invite within 24h of signup.	RELIABILITY PROOF 0 “Preview ≠ sent card” bugs post-launch . Hard gate — must stay at zero.	RSVP RESPONSE RATE % % invited guests who respond (Yes/No/Maybe) without reminder.	RETENTION D7 / D30 Cohort retention at day 7 and day 30. V2 decides audience narrowing.
FREE → PREMIUM % Conversion rate to paid tier (monthly / annual).	APP STORE RATING 4.5+ Target rating on iOS & Android stores.	CHATBOT DEFLECTION % % queries resolved without human escalation .	ANALYTICS SPEC Detailed event taxonomy & tracking plan delivered as companion Analytics Spec prior to Week 3 build start.

SECTION 12 — FROM KICKOFF TO APP STORE

12 **Timeline — Lean Build, 12 to 14 Weeks**

Scope discipline is the schedule. No AI, one send channel, and curated templates compress a typical 6-month build into a focused quarter.

WEEKS	FOCUS	VISUAL
1 – 2	Design system lock, IA finalized, template design begins	FOUNDATION
3 – 6	Core build: auth, create flow, editor engine (WYSIWYG canvas)	CORE BUILD — EDITOR IS THE PRODUCT
7 – 9	RSVP / guest management, Google Calendar sync, offline queueing, email sending	SYSTEMS INTEGRATION
10 – 11	Chatbot integration, QA pass (editor accuracy + email deliverability are hard gates), template finalization	HARD-GATE QA
12 – 14	Beta testing, polish, app store submission	BETA → LAUNCH

SCHEDULE CONFIDENCE

Template production is decoupled from engineering. Launch with **8–10 templates/category (~150–180 total)** rather than waiting for full 200. Add weekly post-launch. Engineering is never blocked by content.

SECTION 13 — WHAT COULD SLOW US DOWN & HOW WE ALREADY ANSWERED IT

13 **Risks & Assumptions**

Four risks, each with a pre-decided mitigation. No open “we’ll figure it out later.”

RISK	MITIGATION / DECISION	OWNER / GATE
 Template Production Bottleneck	Launch with 8–10 templates/category (~150–180 total) rather than waiting for full 200. Add weekly post-launch. Engineering velocity is never gated by design throughput.	DESIGN LEAD
 WYSIWYG Accuracy = Release Gate	QA must test editor-preview vs. sent-output parity across ≥ 3 device sizes before launch. Not a “nice-to-have.” 0 bugs is a KPI (\$11). If parity fails, launch slips — no exceptions.	QA • HARD GATE
 Email Deliverability = Premium Trust	SPF / DKIM / DMARC + Mail-Tester ≥ 9/10 required pre-launch. A card landing in spam defeats the entire premium positioning. Transactional domain warmed before beta.	ENG • HARD GATE
 Offline Conflict Simplicity	V1 rule: local timestamp always wins on sync. No merge UI. Server version silently overwritten. Eliminates ambiguity without complexity. Accepted trade-off: editing same draft on two devices before sync may lose one version. <i>Documented in-app as known limitation.</i>	ENG • ACCEPTED
 Cultural Accuracy	Indian festival templates require domain-expert review (symbol accuracy, color appropriateness, text correctness). Visual-only approval risks cultural insensitivity that damages trust irreparably. No template ships without sign-off.	CULTURAL REVIEWER

ASSUMPTION LOG

Users prefer reliability over breadth at launch • Email-only sending satisfies V1 RSVP workflow • Google Calendar covers majority of host needs • English + Hindi covers V1 audience • Managed BaaS (Firebase/Supabase) handles scale to first 100k users without custom infra • Template quality (200 curated) beats volume (1000+ marketplace).

APPENDIX A — DO NOT SHIP WITHOUT THESE

Release Gates Checklist

PRE-LAUNCH GATES (MUST BE GREEN)

- WYSIWYG parity verified on iPhone SE, Pixel 7, iPad Mini
- Fonts preloaded via CDN — no FOUT on canvas init
- 5 MB → 1080p WebP compression verified
- Mail-Tester ≥ 9/10 on all transactional templates
- SPF / DKIM / DMARC configured & verified
- Cultural review signed off for all 5 Indian festival sets
- “Saved — will send when back online” copy in-app
- Analytics Spec companion delivered (Week 3)

POST-LAUNCH HEALTH (FIRST 30 DAYS)

- 0 “preview ≠ sent” bug reports
- Activation ≥ target within 24h window
- RSVP response rate tracked (with vs. without reminder)
- Free → Premium conversion by occasion
- App Store rating ≥ 4.5 trend
- Chatbot deflection rate weekly
- Template usage: which festivals / evergreen over-index
- Weekly template drops to reach 200 total

SIGN-OFF

Product • Design • Engineering • QA
Cultural Reviewer

End of PRD V1.0 — Invitation & Greeting Card App • Qwen Refined • Zero AI Content in V1 • One codebase, nine screens, 200 templates, one promise: what you see is what they get.